Case Study Handouts

Workplace Essential Skills – SP-211009

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These case studies are designed for classroom, hybrid and online facilitation. Facilitators may use them for group discussions, roleplays, assessments and reflection activities.

Case Study 1: Poor Workplace Communication

Scenario:

Thabo works in the administration department of a company. His supervisor sent an important instruction by email regarding a client report that needed to be completed before Friday. Thabo did not check his emails regularly and missed the instruction. As a result, the report was submitted late and the client complained to management. The supervisor became frustrated and accused Thabo of being irresponsible in front of the team.

Discussion Questions:

1. What communication problems can you identify?
2. How could the situation have been handled better?
3. What responsibilities did both the supervisor and employee have?
4. What workplace communication methods could improve this situation?

Suggested Activity: Group Discussion and Feedback Session

Case Study 2: Unsafe Workplace Behaviour

Scenario:

A warehouse employee repeatedly refuses to wear protective safety boots and gloves because he says they are uncomfortable. One day, heavy equipment falls near his workstation and he narrowly avoids injury. Management realises that several employees are also ignoring safety rules and no recent safety training has taken place.

Discussion Questions:

1. What workplace safety risks are present?
2. What are the responsibilities of the employer?
3. What are the responsibilities of employees?
4. How can the organisation improve workplace safety?

Suggested Activity: Hazard Identification Exercise

Case Study 3: Employee Performance Challenges

Scenario:

Nomusa is a customer service employee who has recently started missing deadlines and making mistakes in client documents. Her manager notices that she appears stressed and withdrawn during meetings. Other employees have started complaining that they have to correct her work. The manager wants to address the issue professionally and supportively.

Discussion Questions:

1. What signs of poor performance are visible?
2. What could be causing the problem?
3. How should the manager address the situation?
4. What performance improvement strategies can help Nomusa?

Suggested Activity: Roleplay a Performance Review Meeting

Case Study 4: Workplace Ethics and Honesty

Scenario:

Sipho notices that one of his colleagues regularly leaves work early but still records a full working day on the attendance register. The colleague asks Sipho not to tell anyone because he is dealing with personal problems at home. Sipho feels uncomfortable because he values honesty, but he also does not want to damage the relationship.

Discussion Questions:

1. What ethical issues are present in this scenario?
2. What should Sipho do?
3. What could happen if the behaviour continues?
4. Why are ethics important in the workplace?

Suggested Activity: Ethics Debate and Reflection

Case Study 5: Workplace Organisation Problems

Scenario:

At a small company, documents are stored randomly on employees' computers without proper file names or folders. Important invoices are often lost and employees spend a lot of time searching for information. Customers are becoming frustrated because of delayed responses and incorrect information.

Discussion Questions:

1. What organisational problems can you identify?
2. How does poor organisation affect productivity?
3. What systems or tools could improve the situation?
4. How can employees contribute to better workplace organisation?

Suggested Activity: Design an Organised Filing System

Facilitator Notes

- Divide learners into small groups for discussion.
- Allow learners to present feedback after discussions.
- Encourage learners to relate scenarios to real workplace experiences.
- Use the activities as formative assessment evidence.
- Take attendance photos or screenshots during online sessions for evidence collection.